



AI & Partners

Amsterdam - London - Singapore

EU AI Act

Malta

AI Ecosystem Brief

November 2025

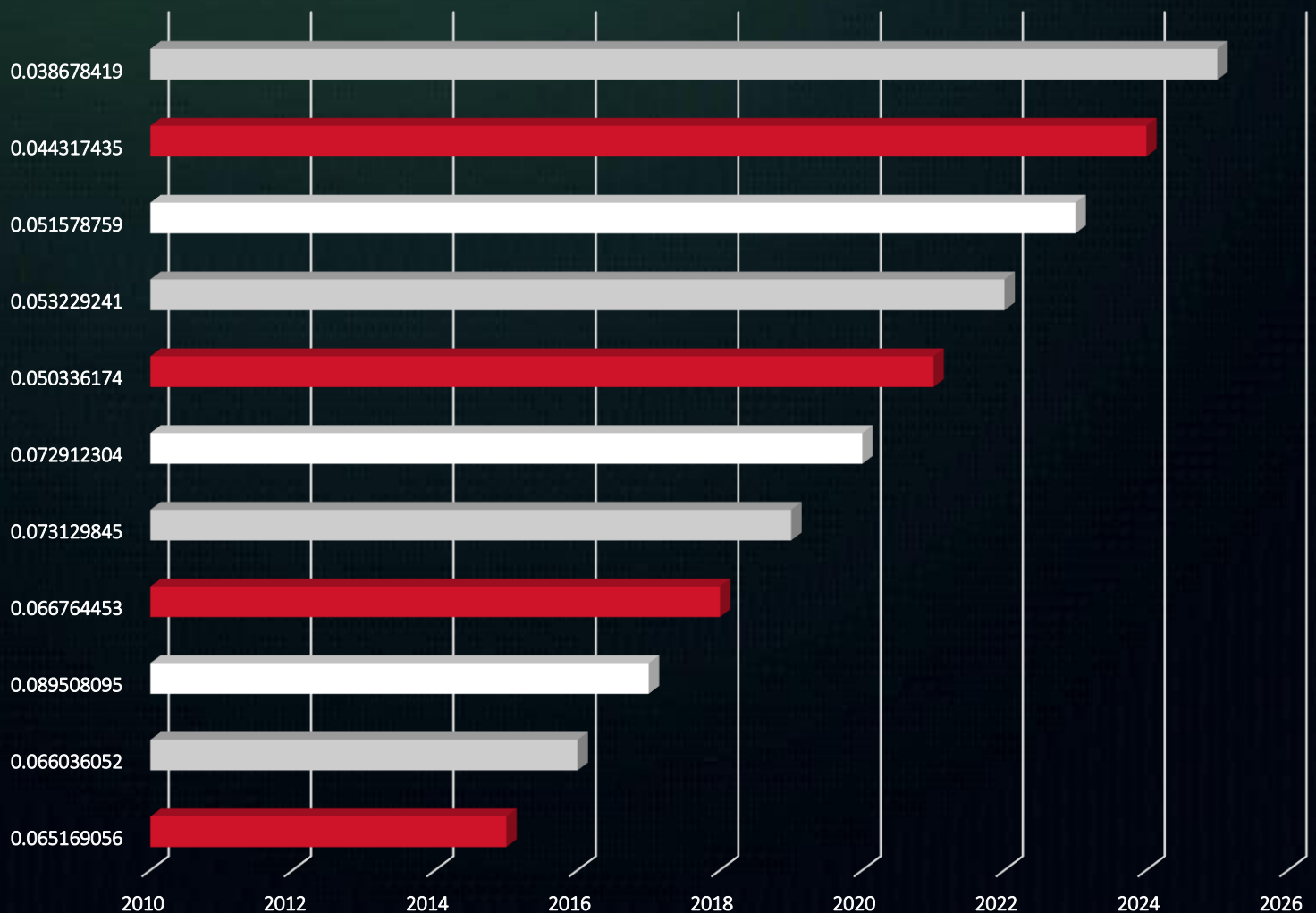
Acknowledgements

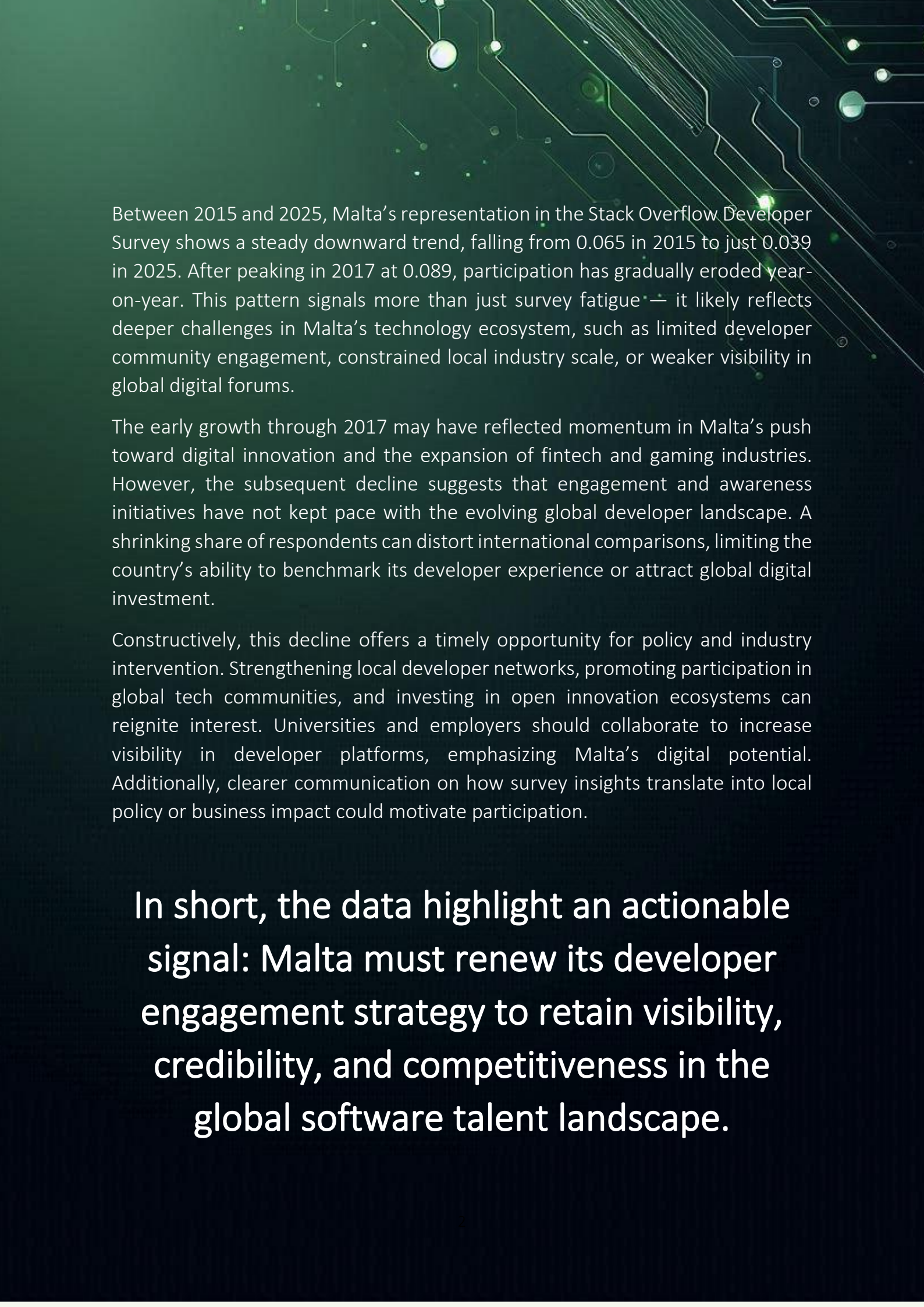
Sean Musch, Michael Borrelli, Charles Kerrigan, Valentina Diaco, Sam Bobev, Beniamino Santoro, Dr. Ian Gauci, Staffan Engström, Wesley Ellul, Gerasimos Papaleventis, Narcis Gavrilescu, Christopher Grech Bonett, Mario Mizzi



Reversing Malta's Developer Engagement Decline: Urgent Strategic Actions Needed to Rebuild Participation, Strengthen Digital Ecosystem, and Sustain Talent Pipeline in the Face of Shrinking Stack Overflow Survey Representation

*Developers in Stack Overflow survey by country
(November 2025)*





Between 2015 and 2025, Malta's representation in the Stack Overflow Developer Survey shows a steady downward trend, falling from 0.065 in 2015 to just 0.039 in 2025. After peaking in 2017 at 0.089, participation has gradually eroded year-on-year. This pattern signals more than just survey fatigue — it likely reflects deeper challenges in Malta's technology ecosystem, such as limited developer community engagement, constrained local industry scale, or weaker visibility in global digital forums.

The early growth through 2017 may have reflected momentum in Malta's push toward digital innovation and the expansion of fintech and gaming industries. However, the subsequent decline suggests that engagement and awareness initiatives have not kept pace with the evolving global developer landscape. A shrinking share of respondents can distort international comparisons, limiting the country's ability to benchmark its developer experience or attract global digital investment.

Constructively, this decline offers a timely opportunity for policy and industry intervention. Strengthening local developer networks, promoting participation in global tech communities, and investing in open innovation ecosystems can reignite interest. Universities and employers should collaborate to increase visibility in developer platforms, emphasizing Malta's digital potential. Additionally, clearer communication on how survey insights translate into local policy or business impact could motivate participation.

In short, the data highlight an actionable signal: Malta must renew its developer engagement strategy to retain visibility, credibility, and competitiveness in the global software talent landscape.



AI & Partners

Amsterdam - London - Singapore

Who Are We

AI That You Can Trust

Why Us?

Stay on the right side of history. At AI & Partners, we believe AI should unlock potential—not cause harm. We've seen the fear and fallout when teams lose control of AI, but also the trust and innovation that follow when it's handled responsibly. That's why we exist: to help you build AI you can trust and stand behind—for the long run.

80%

of AI systems
are unknown

What Do We Do?

We enable safe AI usage—for your organization and your clients. Unknown AI adoption leads to confusion, risk, and reputational damage. We help you take control with tools to identify, monitor, and govern all AI systems—so you're not reacting to AI, you're leading it.

How Do We Do It?

Do you know what AI systems you have? Identify all known and unknown AI systems (algorithms, LLMs, prompts, and models) from all internal and external AI vendors, automated by generating your inventory. Overall, 80% of AI inventory is unknown to our clients.

How do you guarantee ongoing safe AI use? Continuously monitor deployed AI systems for performance drift, anomalies or failures, real-world impacts, and emerging risks (e.g. data poisoning). Any malfunction of an AI system has severe implications for organisations (e.g. inability to assess online misinformation that leads to widespread public mistrust), so monitoring becomes a matter of urgency.



AI Discovery & AI Inventory

Automatically detect all AI systems, including models, algorithms, and prompts, and maintain a live, always-updated register for full visibility and compliance.



Responsible AI

Embed fairness, transparency, and control into every stage of AI use—aligning with the EU AI Act and building 'Trustworthy-by-Design'.



Model Monitoring

Continuously track your AI models after deployment to detect drift, bias, or failure—so you stay in control and prevent harm before it happens.

Contents

This section outlines the structure of the report, detailing chapters on Malta's AI policy landscape, regulatory initiatives, governance mechanisms, findings, and recommendations. It serves as a navigation guide, enabling readers to quickly locate specific analyses, datasets, and policy discussions relevant to Malta's evolving artificial intelligence ecosystem.

Who Are We	3
Contents	4
Overview	6
Specific AI Governance	

or Law	8
Malta's National	10
AI Strategy	10
Approach to	13
AI Regulation	13
The EU AI Act as Supranational Backbone	13
National Strategy: Malta the Ultimate AI Launchpad 2030	14
Institutional Architecture: MDIA and the Emerging Ethics Committee	14
Ethical Governance: Towards Trustworthy AI	15
Certification and Compliance Tool-Kit	15
Funding and Innovation Programmes	15
Sectoral Pilots: From Roads to Reservoirs	16
Intellectual Property, Data Protection, and Liability	17

Intellectual Property	17
Data Protection	17
Civil Liability.....	17
Forward-Looking Challenges and Opportunities	18
Approach to Foster Innovation.....	19
1. Unlocking Economic Value through Targeted AI Deployment	20
2. Catalysing Innovation through Strategic Clustering and Ecosystems	20
3. Enabling Trusted and Responsible Data Use	20
4. Scaling AI in the Public Sector	20
5. Advancing Compute and Research Infrastructure.....	21
6. Empowering SMEs and Startups	21
7. Developing a Future-Ready Workforce.....	21
8. Aligning AI Innovation with Sustainability Goals.....	22
9. Building Public Trust and Ethical AI.....	22
10. Shaping Global AI Governance and Standards	22
Digital Decade 2025: Report	23
Government AI Readiness	25
Government.....	26
Technology Sector	27
Data & infrastructure Sector	27
Conclusion	28
Appendix A: Expert Vignettes.....	30
Sam Boboev, <i>Founder, FinTech Wrap Up</i>	31
Biography.....	31
Valentina Diaco, <i>Founder, Profit Matches</i>	32
Real-World Testbed for Applied AI	32
AI Match by Profit Matches	32
Accelerator Collaborations to Drive Innovation	33
Three-Pronged Opportunity	33
Biography.....	33
Beniamino Santoro, <i>Group DPO, EveryMatrix</i>	34
Biography.....	35
Appendix B: OECD AI Progress Report	36
References.....	39

Overview

Malta has no standalone AI law but aligns with the EU AI Act, effective August 2026. Its 2019 national AI strategy and the Malta Digital Innovation Authority guide AI governance and innovation. Malta supports AI through grants, research, and regulatory updates, aiming to be a regional AI leader.

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is reshaping economies and governance worldwide, and Malta is establishing itself as a proactive advocate of ethical and human-centric AI within the European Union. Anchored in the EU's evolving regulatory landscape, Malta has adopted an alignment-driven approach that emphasizes rights-based safeguards, regulatory experimentation, and fostering innovation. Rather than introducing standalone AI legislation, Malta is leveraging its national AI strategy and soft-law instruments to promote trustworthy AI development.

At the heart of Malta's evolving AI governance strategy is its direct implementation of the EU AI Act, which will apply as of August 2, 2026. A distinctive feature of Malta's approach is its proactive stance on innovation through initiatives like the MDIA AI Applied Research Grant, which provides funding for AI research projects, fostering a learning environment for piloting AI



systems. These are complemented by strategic resources such as the National AI Strategy ("Malta the Ultimate AI Launchpad: A Strategy and Vision for Artificial Intelligence in Malta 2030") and the Ethical AI Framework ("Towards Trustworthy AI"), which together articulate a vision for safe AI.

Malta's governance model is underpinned by a multi-actor institutional architecture. The Malta Digital Innovation Authority (MDIA) plays a central role in developing the innovative technology sector and realigning the national AI strategy. The intention is also for a National Technology Ethics Committee to be set up under the MDIA to oversee the Ethical AI Framework. These efforts reflect a whole-of-society approach to embedding AI governance.

Malta also shows strong commitment to international standards. As an EU member state, the country aligns closely with EU-wide strategies like the EU AI Act. Through these channels, Malta ensures its domestic practices remain interoperable and globally relevant, reinforcing its image as a constructive contributor to human-centric AI governance.

Aligned with its National AI Strategy, the country is targeting key sectors—including transport, citizen services, and energy—for AI-enabled transformation. Strategic initiatives and policy instruments, such as the government's planned AI projects to improve citizen services, guide practical, accountable deployment. The Strategy also emphasizes the importance of education and workforce development, helping build a skilled, future-ready workforce.

Malta's data and infrastructure capabilities also reinforce its AI readiness. The National AI Strategy calls for robust digital infrastructure and connectivity to support effective AI applications. Its alignment with EU instruments concerning data governance and efforts to enhance data quality and availability underscore a future-facing commitment to scalable, trustworthy data use.

Through this combination of EU-aligned oversight, innovation-driven approaches, and globally harmonized ethics frameworks, Malta is building a comprehensive, adaptive model of AI governance. As a result of prioritizing human rights, transparency, and practical application, Malta is charting a pragmatic course toward AI that is both innovative and democratically grounded.

Specific AI Governance or Law

Malta has no standalone AI law but aligns with the EU AI Act, effective August 2026. Its 2019 national AI strategy and the Malta Digital Innovation Authority guide AI governance and innovation. Malta supports AI through grants, research, and regulatory updates, aiming to be an AI leader.

EU AI Act — timing and national implementation milestones. The EU AI Act entered into force in 2024 and the main obligations become applicable on 2 August 2026. Note the staggered implementation timeline: the ban on AI practices judged to be “prohibited” (unacceptable risk) took effect earlier, on 2 February 2025, and Member States were required to establish or designate national competent authorities (and a single point of contact) by 2 August 2025. Under Malta’s implementation plan, the Office of the Information and Data Protection Commissioner (IDPC) has been designated to carry out the data-protection supervisory functions (FRA) and is expected to be assigned market-surveillance responsibilities for specific high-risk domains (including AI systems used for law enforcement, border management and justice) as part of the national authority designations due by August 2025. These sequencing rules mean that some prohibitions and transparency requirements are already in force while full conformity and high-risk obligations follow the 2026 application date.



In addition to the Strategy, Malta created the Malta Digital Innovation Authority ("MDIA") in 2018, tasked with developing the innovative technology sector through proper recognition and regulation of relevant innovative technology arrangements and related services. The MDIA is currently realigning the Strategy, prompted by the fact that 80% of the Strategy has been partially or fully implemented and due to significant regulatory developments since 2019. The MDIA is also receiving feedback from industry stakeholders on necessary updates to the Strategy. Following the repeal of the Innovative Technology Arrangements and Services ("ITAS") Act, a new voluntary certification system was launched via the ITAS Certification Regulations (Subsidiary Legislation 591.01). AI is explicitly listed as an innovative technology falling within the scope of the ITAS Regulations.

To foster innovation, the MDIA, in collaboration with the (then) Ministry for the Economy and Industry, launched a €125,000 fund for AI research projects called the MDIA AI Applied Research Grant in January 2022. Applicants can receive up to €40,000 for their projects. To date, €284,217 has been distributed among nine projects covering initiatives from sustainable tourism to cosmological studies. The latest call for applications for the grant launched on April 2, 2024. Further support is provided by Xjenza Malta, a government agency established in 2024, which offers various funding projects for research, development, and innovation. Malta has explored the implementation of AI systems in various sectors, including transport, to address daily road congestion. Researchers at the University of Malta have studied the feasibility of introducing "driverless" vehicles using AI systems under the Malta's Introduction of Shared Autonomous Mobility ("MISAM") project, which also explores the legislative framework and proposes solutions for gaps in Maltese law, such as liability for autonomous vehicle accidents. Separately, an innovative research project on autonomous buses launched in May 2021, with testing pushed back to early 2025.

The Maltese government has also planned six more AI projects to improve citizen services and strengthen its position as an AI hub. These include collaborations between Enemalta and Automated Revenue Management Services for data analysis on water and electricity usage, and the Malta Tourism Authority's use of AI-generated personas for demographic data in tourism. In 2025, Malta's Energy & Water Agency and the Water Services Corporation were reportedly testing AI programs to predict and manage water supplies. The Maltese government has also collaborated with Microsoft to implement its expertise and technology in government projects.

Malta's National AI Strategy

Malta's AI governance approach is grounded in a value-driven, EU-aligned framework that combines ethical safeguards, public sector leadership, and technological innovation to promote responsible AI deployment. Through instruments like the National AI Strategy, the government's ongoing efforts to update this strategy, and emerging regulatory mechanisms, Malta fosters trustworthy AI adoption.

Malta's AI governance model is built on foundational principles including trustworthiness, human-centricity, fairness, transparency, and respect for individual and collective rights—values strongly aligned with EU and OECD guidelines. While the EU AI Act provides the overarching legislative framework, Malta's approach complements this through its National AI Strategy, a comprehensive document from 2019 that defines ethical, regulatory, and innovation pathways for AI development.



Unlike Singapore's voluntary, sector-led frameworks, Malta leans on coordinated public governance and alignment with EU mandates, promoting national cohesion and international interoperability. A defining trait of Malta's model is its emphasis on inclusive and rights-based governance.

The Strategy explicitly outlines the importance of embedding ethical principles into AI development and deployment, with the intention of a National Technology Ethics Committee being set up under the Malta Digital Innovation Authority (MDIA) to oversee the Ethical AI Framework. This framework, "Towards Trustworthy AI", published in August 2019, aims to establish guiding principles and trustworthy AI governance and control practices.

The MDIA plays a crucial role in developing the innovative technology sector and in realigning the Strategy, prompted by regulatory developments since 2019 and feedback from industry stakeholders. Malta also adopts a context-aware and risk-sensitive stance. The Strategy prioritizes societal benefits and addresses challenges, supporting AI deployment in areas like transport and citizen services.

While not explicitly called an "AI Sandbox", Malta fosters innovation through initiatives like the MDIA AI Applied Research Grant, which provides funding for AI research projects, demonstrating a commitment to responsible AI deployment in a controlled environment for learning and development. The Strategy advocates for embedding AI governance into both corporate operations and public administration.

It identifies key pillars such as infrastructure, education and workforce, ethical and legal frameworks, and a public sector adoption. Responsibility for ethical deployment is distributed across developers, public institutions, and civil society, aligning with cooperative governance models while maintaining state-led coordination. The Maltese government's planned AI projects to improve citizen services further demonstrate this commitment.

Capacity building, regional equity, and inclusion are also central to Malta's framework. The Strategy emphasizes the need to attract foreign direct investment, improve the local workforce's AI capabilities, and ensure a robust digital infrastructure.

The government's collaboration with Microsoft to implement its expertise and technology in government projects and facilitate the development and training

of early-stage AI startups further underscores this commitment to capacity building and an innovation ecosystem.

Finally, Malta's approach is not static. The Strategy is presented as a living document, and the MDIA is actively engaged in realigning it to account for new developments and feedback from stakeholders. This mirrors Singapore's agile governance model, though Malta's use of national institutions like the MDIA and the planned National Technology Ethics Committee to guide such evolution underscores a more structured and institutionalized path toward AI maturity.

**Education and
Workforce**

**Ethical and
Legal**

**Ecosystem
Infrastructure**

Approach to AI Regulation

Malta, bound by the EU AI Act from August 2026, has no standalone AI law but follows a proactive strategy launched in 2019. Through the Malta Digital Innovation Authority, certification schemes, funding initiatives, and cross-sector AI projects, Malta promotes innovation, regulatory alignment, and positions itself as a regional AI hub.

Malta's approach to artificial-intelligence governance is neither a laissez-faire free-for-all nor a rigid regime of bespoke statutes. Instead, the island nation relies on the forthcoming **EU AI Act** as its legal anchor while layering on an ambitious national strategy, specialised institutions, and a dense web of sector-specific tools. Since launching *Malta the Ultimate AI Launchpad* in 2019, policymakers have sought to position Malta as a safe test-bed for innovation, arguing that a small, agile jurisdiction can trial novel regulatory ideas faster than a continental heavyweight. As 2026—the date the bulk of the EU Act's obligations take effect—edges closer, Malta is realigning its frameworks to ensure both compliance with Brussels and continued local dynamism.

The EU AI Act as Supranational Backbone

Because Malta is an EU Member State, the AI Act—effective 1 August 2024, fully applicable from 2 August 2026—forms the bedrock of its legislative architecture.



The Act's **risk-based taxonomy** (minimal, limited, high, and prohibited use-cases) supplies a harmonised vocabulary, mandatory conformity assessments for high-risk systems, and tough penalties for non-compliance. Rather than drafting an all-new statute that might duplicate or, worse, contradict this framework, Malta's lawmakers are **mapping domestic rules to the EU classifications**. Ministries are cataloguing which public-sector deployments fall under "high risk" (for example, biometric identification in border control) and drafting template procurement clauses that compel suppliers to carry CE-style markings once the Act bites.

National Strategy: Malta the Ultimate AI Launchpad 2030

Launched on 3 October 2019, Malta's National AI Strategy (NAIS 2030) articulates three headline goals:

1. **Forge a sustainable AI ecosystem** delivering economic growth and foreign investment.
2. **Mitigate risks** without stifling experimentation.
3. **Brand Malta** as a "laboratory island" where global firms can pilot frontier models.

Seven thematic pillars underpin these ambitions—scientific research, industry adoption, education, ethics, public administration, legal certainty, and social inclusion. Annual action plans track key performance indicators such as the number of AI startups incorporated, university research outputs, and citizens trained through digital-skills programmes. While an internal review in 2024 found 80 percent of actions either completed or in flight, it also identified regulatory gaps around autonomous mobility and AI-generated content, prompting a strategy refresh now underway.

Institutional Architecture: MDIA and the Emerging Ethics Committee

Created in 2018, the **Malta Digital Innovation Authority (MDIA)** is the country's central node for tech oversight. Its statutory mandate spans accreditation of "innovative technology arrangements," issuance of voluntary certifications, and advisory opinions to other regulators. MDIA's **Regulatory Sandbox**, launched in 2021, lets firms deploy AI solutions under relaxed conditions while reporting granular risk metrics; lessons learned feed into future rule-making.

To complement MDIA's technical remit, government plans to establish a **National Technology Ethics Committee** with multidisciplinary membership—lawyers, ethicists, engineers, civil-society voices. The committee's brief is to monitor



implementation of the *Towards Trustworthy AI* framework, evaluate high-profile deployments, and flag systemic harms such as algorithmic discrimination. Although enabling legislation is still in draft, pilot working groups have already advised on facial-recognition trials at Malta International Airport and energy-demand forecasting tools used by state utilities.

Ethical Governance: Towards Trustworthy AI

First published in draft form in August 2019 and finalised two months later, *Towards Trustworthy AI* aligns with the EU's High-Level Expert Group principles—lawfulness, fairness, transparency, accountability, and societal well-being. Malta's framework converts these aspirations into **practical control points**: bias audits for training data, explainability thresholds for high-impact decisions, and mandatory human-override mechanisms. MDIA maintains a reference implementation guide, updated quarterly, that matches specific ISO/IEC standards (e.g., 23894 on AI risk management) to each principle. Organisations seeking MDIA certification submit a self-assessment against these controls, after which external auditors perform spot checks.

Certification and Compliance Tool-Kit

Following the 2024 repeal of the Innovative Technology Arrangements and Services Act, Malta introduced the **ITAS Certification Regulations** (Subsidiary Legislation 591.01). AI sits explicitly within scope, allowing providers to apply for a **voluntary “Innovative Technology Compliance Certificate.”** While not a legal prerequisite, the badge functions as a market signal—locally tendering government agencies often award extra points to certified bidders. The certification schema mirrors the EU AI Act's Annex VIII technical dossier but adds Maltese wrinkles, such as mandatory disclosures on energy efficiency (consistent with the country's climate strategy) and sandbox-exit reporting.

Funding and Innovation Programmes

Malta backs policy with cash. In January 2022, MDIA and the then-Ministry for the Economy and Industry established the **AI Applied Research Grant** worth €125 000, capping awards at €40 000 per project. As of mid-2025, nine grantees—ranging from cosmology simulations to sustainable-tourism recommender engines—have secured a collective €284 217. A fresh call in April 2024 emphasised **health-tech and maritime logistics**, both priority sectors in Malta's smart-specialisation roadmap. Parallel mechanisms bolster the pipeline:

- **Xjenza Malta**, a 2024-founded agency, dispenses broader R&D vouchers covering cloud compute credits and patent-filing fees.
- **Malta Enterprise** partners with Microsoft to waive Azure costs for early-stage AI startups, contingent on on-island job creation.
- Tax incentives under the **Investment Aid Regulations** extend a 35 percent credit for qualifying AI capital expenditures.

Collectively, these levers cultivate what policymakers dub “*the four-minute ecosystem*: in the time it takes to walk Valletta’s main street, you can meet a regulator, an investor, and a test customer.” **EU4Health — BreastScan (AI in radiology)**. In February 2025 Malta joined the EU4Health-funded **BreastScan** project, a four-year multi-country initiative to integrate AI tools into breast-cancer screening and radiology workflows. Maltese participation includes clinical and imaging specialists from Mater Dei Hospital and is intended to accelerate safe, evaluated deployments of AI for screening, diagnostic support and quality assurance.

Sectoral Pilots: From Roads to Reservoirs

Malta uses its compact geography as a living laboratory:

- **Autonomous Mobility** – The University of Malta’s *MISAM* project assesses legal and technical feasibility of driverless shuttles. Draft bills envisage conditional exemptions from road-traffic rules, coupled with strict data-logging obligations to aid accident forensics. Field testing, delayed by supply-chain disruptions, is slated for early 2025.
- **Public Utilities Optimisation** – Enemalta (electricity) and Automated Revenue Management Services crunch smart-meter data with reinforcement-learning models to fine-tune load balancing. Preliminary pilots cut peak-demand spikes by 7 percent.
- **Tourism Analytics** – The Malta Tourism Authority deploys synthetic “visitor personas” generated by large language models to forecast seasonal flows and recommend bespoke packages to small hotels.
- **Water Resources** – In 2025, the Energy & Water Agency and the Water Services Corporation began testing AI that predicts aquifer recharge rates, aiming to slash desalination costs.



Each pilot is accompanied by an MDIA-approved impact-assessment template that logs performance metrics, bias checks, and citizen-feedback loops. Data from these pilots feed back into regulatory updates, illustrating Malta's **iterative, evidence-led style**.

Intellectual Property, Data Protection, and Liability

Intellectual Property

Maltese copyright law safeguards “computer programs” as literary works, granting developers rights over AI source code. Yet AI-generated outputs fall into a statutory void because authorship attaches only to natural persons. Policymakers are exploring **contractual default clauses** that assign ownership to the deploying entity, but until EU-level reform materialises, courts must improvise via analogies to joint authorship or database rights. Patentability guidance for AI inventions remains similarly opaque; applicants receive case-by-case rulings from the Industrial Property Registrations Directorate.

Data Protection

The GDPR applies wholesale, with particular scrutiny on **automated decision-making under Article 22**. Malta's Information & Data Protection Commissioner has signalled willingness to interpret “legitimate interest” narrowly where high-risk AI is concerned. Law-enforcement data crawling has sparked debate, pitting crime-detection benefits against proportionality obligations; a forthcoming code of practice is expected to clarify acceptable thresholds.

Health-sector secondary processing (S.L. 528.10). Malta's Processing of Personal Data (Secondary Processing) (Health Sector) Regulations (S.L. 528.10), enacted under the Health Act (Cap. 528), explicitly govern secondary processing of health data. The Regulations provide a lawful framework under which health-care providers and designated health authorities may carry out secondary processing of patient data for public-health purposes and for research and statistics, subject to appropriate safeguards. In practice this enables hospitals and other health-sector bodies to reuse patient data for approved research and quality-improvement activities while requiring supervision, data-minimisation and procedural safeguards consistent with the GDPR.

Civil Liability

Absent bespoke rules, victims of AI-related harm must sue under traditional tort provisions of the Civil Code, typically targeting the developer or operator. Maltese judges have hinted that failing to install adequate “fail-safes” could

constitute negligence. The EU's proposed AI Liability Directive—meant to streamline such claims—stalled and was withdrawn in 2024, leaving Malta to watch for a successor initiative. Criminal liability for AI agents themselves remains off the table; culpability attaches to natural or legal persons behind the system.

Forward-Looking Challenges and Opportunities

1. **Regulatory Capacity** – As the EU AI Act's conformity-assessment workload grows, MDIA must scale inspectorates and cultivate cross-border mutual-recognition deals to avoid bottlenecks.
2. **Skills Gap** – Despite vibrant grants, Malta's small talent pool risks saturation. Government scholarships with overseas universities and visa-fast-track schemes are mooted.
3. **Energy Footprint** – Running large models strains an island grid reliant on imported LNG and an interconnector to Sicily. Incentives for green data centres and offshore-solar pilots could mitigate emissions.
4. **Public Trust** – Early surveys show mixed sentiment: enthusiasm for AI tourism tools, wariness about facial recognition. Transparent communication and citizen juries could bolster legitimacy.
5. **Geopolitical Alignment** – As global AI blocs coalesce, Malta must reconcile EU standards with partnerships in the Gulf and Asia that may espouse looser norms, all while sustaining its "sandbox" allure.

Handled deftly, these challenges double as opportunities: a credible conformity-assessment hub could lure foreign developers; a renewable-powered data-centre campus could market "carbon-neutral inference."

Malta's AI-governance playbook is layered, pragmatic, and innovation-centric. Anchored by the EU AI Act, it augments supranational law with a national strategy, a dedicated digital-innovation authority, voluntary certification schemes, and generous funding channels. Ethical oversight frameworks and iterative sectoral pilots translate principles into practice, while ongoing debates over IP, privacy, and liability highlight areas for legislative fine-tuning. The next eighteen months, leading up to the AI Act's full applicability in August 2026, will be decisive: expand institutional capacity, close legal lacunae, and convert sandbox experiments into exportable success stories. If Malta succeeds, it may validate the thesis that a micro-state can punch above its weight as both a regulatory petri dish and a commercial launch-pad for trustworthy AI.

Approach to Foster Innovation

Malta's comprehensive approach to AI governance, deployment, and innovation is rooted in human-centric values, resilience-based planning, and globally coordinated action. The National AI Strategy ("Malta the Ultimate AI Launchpad: A Strategy and Vision for Artificial Intelligence in Malta 2030") and ongoing efforts to update this strategy align with international ethical standards and outline strategic objectives aimed at addressing national challenges, enhancing industrial competitiveness, and achieving societal well-being through AI. Malta's implementation spans across critical domains—from education and infrastructure to public services and international collaboration—enabling responsible AI adoption and long-term societal transformation.

1. Unlocking Economic Value through Targeted AI Deployment

Malta's AI strategy focuses on leveraging AI to solve pressing national issues and drive value creation in real-world industries. The National AI Strategy identifies societal and economic opportunities through AI across various sectors. By deploying AI in these high-impact sectors, Malta aims to enhance productivity, improve public services, and contribute to overall societal well-being. This includes exploring AI applications in areas like transport (e.g., driverless vehicles, autonomous buses) and citizen services (e.g., data analysis for utilities, AI-generated personas for tourism). The government actively plans and implements AI projects to improve citizen services.

2. Catalysing Innovation through Strategic Clustering and Ecosystems

Malta fosters innovation through its research and innovation ecosystem, which includes initiatives from the University of Malta and funding bodies like the Malta Digital Innovation Authority (MDIA) and Xjenza Malta. These entities lead research in various AI domains. Strategic partnerships between academia, government, and industry are encouraged to co-create and rapidly implement cutting-edge AI technologies. The MDIA, for instance, launched the MDIA AI Applied Research Grant to support AI research projects, demonstrating a commitment to fostering innovation. Collaboration with international technology companies, such as Microsoft, further exemplifies efforts to leverage external expertise and technology in government projects and support early-stage AI startups.

3. Enabling Trusted and Responsible Data Use

Malta emphasizes responsible AI, integrating ethical considerations with data privacy. These efforts are guided by the "Ethical AI Framework: Towards Trustworthy AI," which aims to establish guiding principles for trustworthy AI governance and control practices. The framework supports AI practitioners in identifying and managing potential risks while promoting higher ethical standards. A key concern is the automated processing of personal data, and the need to balance data subjects' rights with public interest.

4. Scaling AI in the Public Sector

The Maltese government promotes digital transformation through AI integration in public administration. AI is applied to enhance efficiency and effectiveness in public tasks. The government has planned several AI projects specifically to improve citizen services, including collaborations between public entities like Enemalta and Automated Revenue Management Services for data analysis, and



the Malta Tourism Authority for demographic data. The exploration of AI programs by Malta's Energy & Water Agency and the Water Services Corporation for predicting and managing water supplies further demonstrates this focus on public sector AI adoption.

5. Advancing Compute and Research Infrastructure

Malta is investing in R&D infrastructure and compute resources to build a globally competitive AI ecosystem. The National AI Strategy outlines the importance of infrastructure as a strategic pillar. This includes fostering an environment conducive to the development and implementation of AI solutions. Support for research, such as through the MDIA AI Applied Research Grant and Xjenza Malta, contributes to advancing the necessary compute and research infrastructure for effective AI applications.

6. Empowering SMEs and Startups

Support for SMEs and AI startups is integral to Malta's strategy. Malta Enterprise's collaboration with Microsoft to facilitate the development and training of early-stage AI startups by eliminating infrastructure cost barriers is a concrete example of this commitment. This initiative aims to foster an environment where AI startups can thrive and contribute to the economy, aligning with the broader goal of creating a new sector for investment on the Maltese islands.

7. Developing a Future-Ready Workforce

Malta aims to develop a future-ready workforce capable of working with AI. The National AI Strategy identifies "Education and workforce" as a strategic pillar, underscoring the importance of cultivating local talent in the AI field. Initiatives aimed at improving the local workforce's AI capabilities are central to ensuring that Malta has the necessary skills to support its AI ambitions.

Digital Education Strategy 2024–2030 (AI in schools). Malta adopted a new Digital Education Strategy 2024–2030 (May 2024). The Strategy explicitly addresses artificial intelligence in the curriculum: it sets targets for pupils to acquire a basic comprehension of AI during primary schooling and foresees measures to integrate AI literacy and related digital skills across subject areas through to 2030. The Strategy is a core element of Malta's long-term workforce and digital-skills pipeline for AI uptake in the public and private sectors.

8. Aligning AI Innovation with Sustainability Goals

While not explicitly termed "AI for Planetary Resilience," Malta's general approach to AI deployment, as outlined in its National AI Strategy, is framed around building a "sustainable local engine for growth." This implies an alignment of AI innovation with broader societal well-being, which can encompass sustainability goals. The Strategy's aim to address unknown risks of AI without hindering innovation and economic development suggests a balanced approach that would consider the long-term impact, including environmental considerations.

9. Building Public Trust and Ethical AI

Malta's AI governance framework is grounded in trustworthiness and ethical considerations. The "Ethical AI Framework: Towards Trustworthy AI" and the planned National Technology Ethics Committee under the MDIA are key instruments for ensuring that AI development and deployment adhere to ethical principles. This includes addressing issues such as bias and discrimination, and ensuring that AI systems are developed and used responsibly. The emphasis on balancing data subjects' rights with public interest further contributes to building public trust.

10. Shaping Global AI Governance and Standards

Malta, as an EU Member State, is directly bound by the EU AI Act, demonstrating its commitment to aligning with and contributing to global AI governance and standards set at the European level. The ongoing efforts by the MDIA to realign the national AI strategy, considering significant regulatory developments, indicate a proactive approach to evolving with international norms and standards in AI. While specific participation in global soft-law initiatives like the Hiroshima AI Process is not detailed in the provided text, Malta's strong alignment with EU frameworks positions it as a contributor to broader international efforts in responsible AI.

Council of Europe Framework Convention on AI (signature). Malta signed the Council of Europe's Framework Convention on Artificial Intelligence and Human Rights, Democracy and the Rule of Law when the treaty opened for signature on 5 September 2024. The Convention establishes a human-rights and rule-of-law baseline for AI use and is intended to complement EU-level regulation by setting international standards for AI lifecycle governance.

Digital Decade

2025: Report

Artificial Intelligence plays a central role in Malta's push for digital transformation. The country's National AI Strategy is designed to establish Malta as a frontrunner in AI by promoting innovation, ethical development, and investment in the field. As part of the broader digitalisation agenda, the strategy is built around three core themes: investment, adoption, and governance. It promotes AI integration across businesses, supports R&D activities, and introduces regulatory structures to ensure ethical AI implementation.

To support this vision, the Maltese government has introduced measures offering financial incentives, training opportunities, and digital infrastructure aimed at attracting AI-focused businesses. These efforts reinforce Malta's ambition to become a competitive European hub for AI development. According to the 2025 Eurobarometer, 87% of Malta's citizens believe that it is important for public authorities to take the lead in guiding the evolution of AI and other digital technologies in a way that upholds fundamental rights and values.

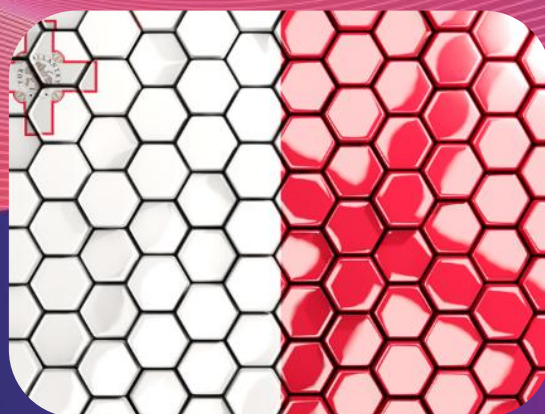
Malta's AI adoption goal for 2030 remains set at 27.2%, as initially outlined in its 2023 roadmap.

In line with the 2024 recommendation on AI, cloud, and data analytics, Malta was advised to:

1. continue its efforts to digitalise businesses by improving access to secure, sovereign digital technologies and encouraging further investment in digital research and innovation;
2. increase awareness of digital technology benefits and boost engagement with available funding programmes—particularly among micro, small, and family-owned enterprises, which are prevalent in the Maltese economy.

In response, Malta initiated several policy actions during 2024. Notably, the “Digitalise your SME” programme was developed and launched in the first quarter of 2025. This scheme provides enhanced financial support through non-repayable grants for projects involving key technologies such as AI, cloud computing, quantum tech, and cybersecurity. These initiatives are aligned with the goals set out in the EU's Digital Decade framework, aiming to accelerate technological adoption among SMEs.

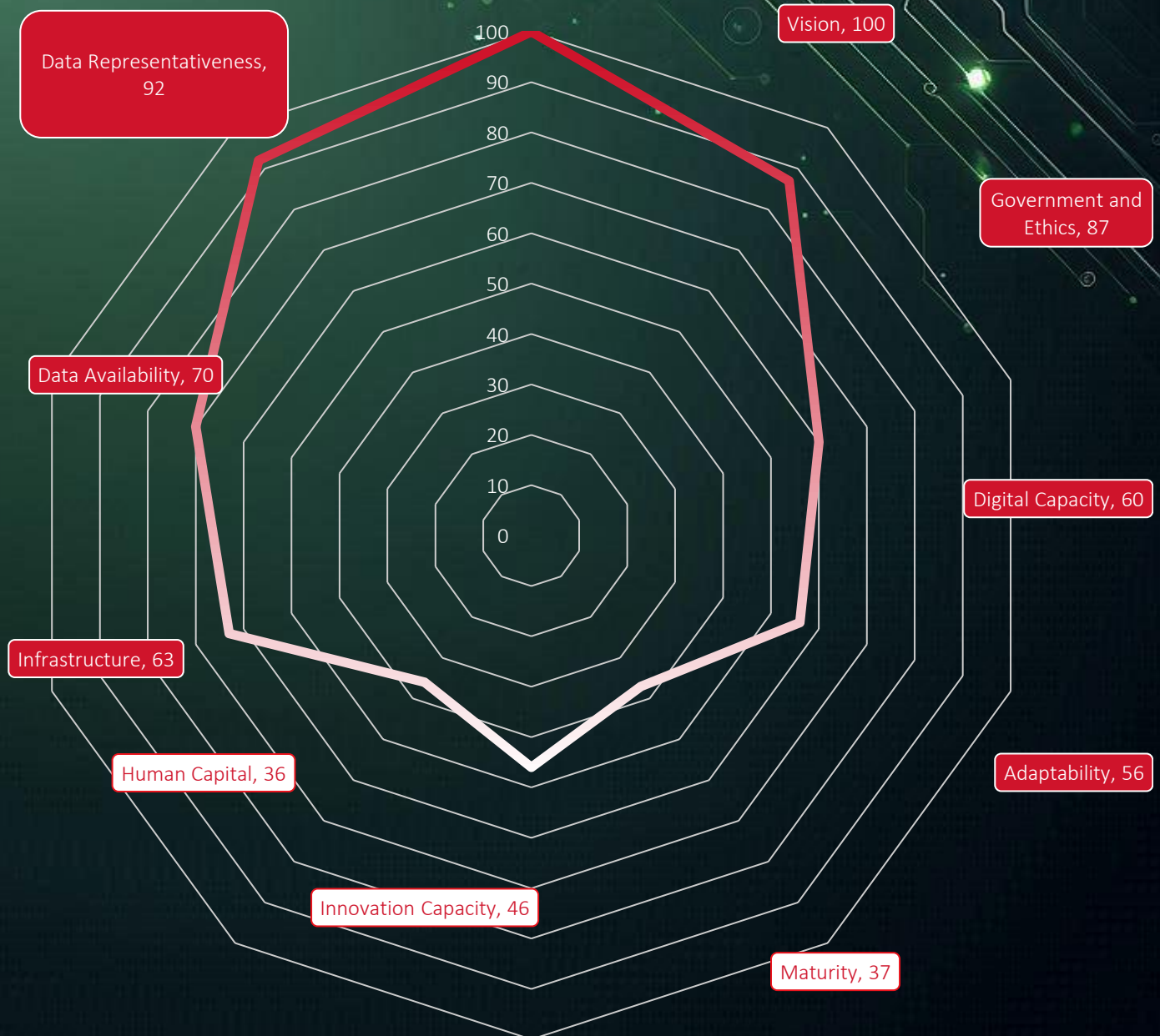
**2030
DIGITAL
COMPASS**



Government AI Readiness

‘Western Europe ranks as the highest-performing region in this year’s Government AI Readiness Index, with five countries in the global top 10. France leads the regional ranking with a score of 79.36, narrowly ahead of the United Kingdom (78.88), followed closely by the Netherlands (77.23), Germany (76.90), and Finland (76.48). With an average regional score of 69.56, Western Europe outperforms the global average (47.59) across all three pillars of Government, Technology, and Data & Infrastructure. The region’s standout strength is the Data & Infrastructure pillar, where it averages 81.91, more than 21 points above the global benchmark (59.62), reflecting its advanced digital infrastructure and high-quality data environment.

2024 Scores by Dimension



Government

Malta posts a Government-pillar score of 75.86, reflecting an active institutional push to operationalise the EU AI Act and embed trustworthy-AI principles across the public sector. As an EU member, Malta is directly implementing the EU AI Act. Regulatory experimentation is supported by initiatives such as the MDIA AI Applied Research Grant, which allows for responsible AI deployment and innovation. Fundamental-rights safeguards stem from the emphasis on an ethical AI framework, ensuring respect for public values and human rights. Measures such as the planned National Technology Ethics Committee underpin a government model that couples EU alignment with robust oversight and capacity-building.

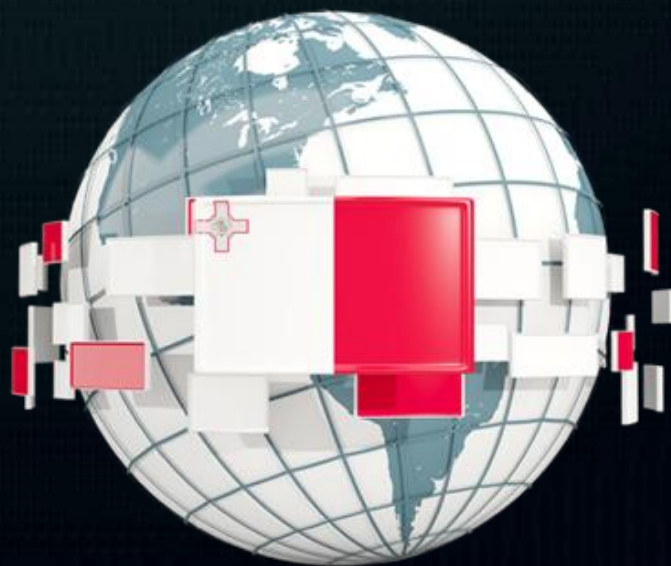
Technology Sector

A Technology-pillar score of 39.89 signals an active, though still developing, innovation ecosystem. Malta's AI market is expanding, fueled by its national AI strategy and initiatives by the Malta Digital Innovation Authority (MDIA) to stimulate AI entrepreneurship and foster an environment where AI startups can thrive. Continued support for research and development, particularly through local grants and international collaborations, will be critical to further strengthen the technology innovation base and support its growth within Europe.

Data & infrastructure Sector

With a score of 75.18, Malta exhibits solid digital foundations and a forward-looking data-governance agenda. As an EU member state, national policy aligns with EU instruments concerning data governance. Malta's National AI Strategy calls for robust digital infrastructure and connectivity to support effective AI applications. These initiatives, coupled with efforts to enhance data quality and availability, create favorable conditions for data-driven AI projects across the economy.

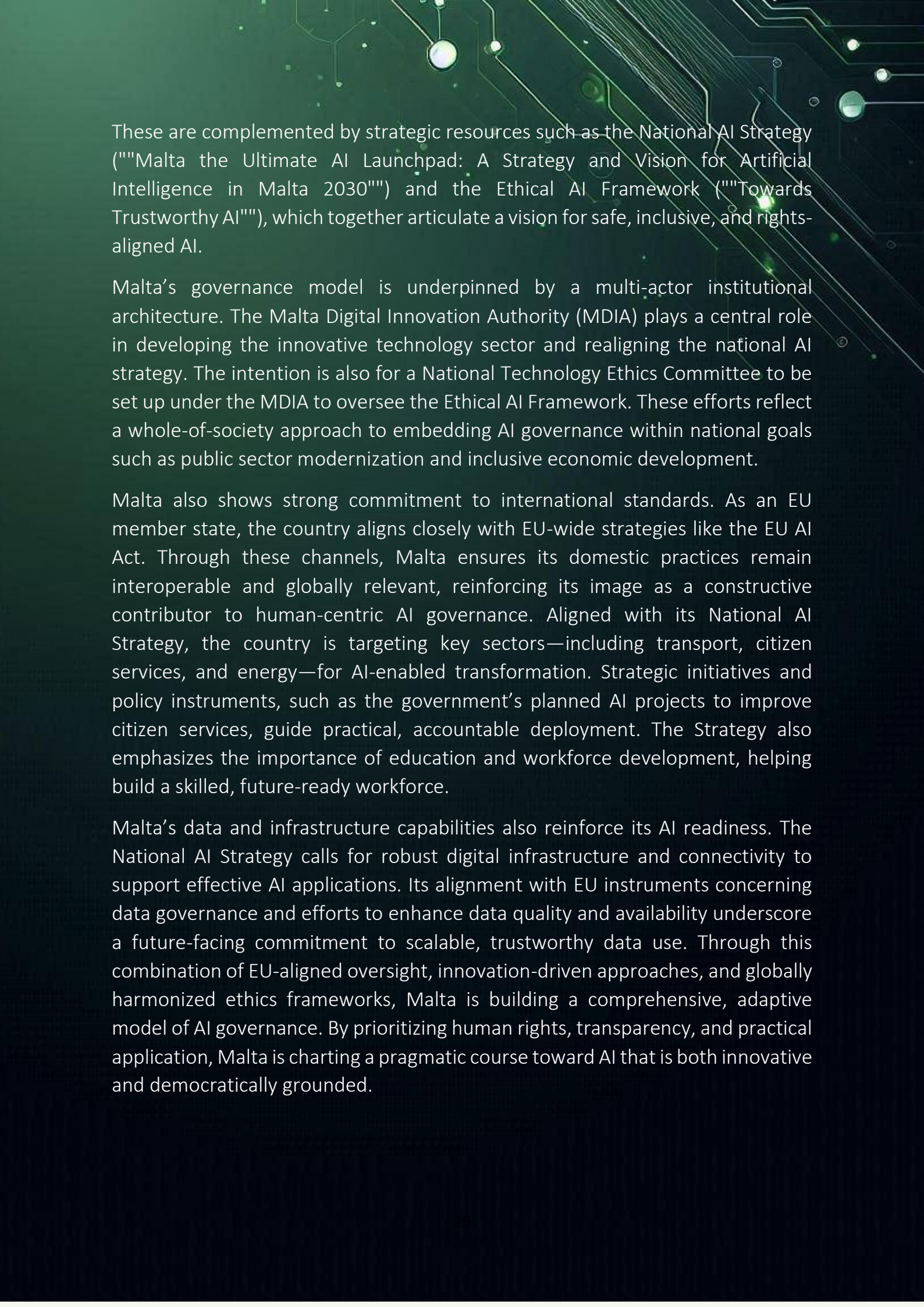
Malta's composite score of 63.64 places it comfortably above the global average (47.59) and reflects its commitment to AI readiness. High scores in the Government and Data & Infrastructure pillars indicate strong foundational strengths, while the Technology pillar shows a growing but still developing innovation ecosystem. Continued progress on supervisory structures, support for innovation, and active participation in international AI governance discussions should consolidate Malta's position as a responsible AI innovator in Europe.



Conclusion

"Artificial Intelligence (AI) is reshaping economies and governance worldwide, and Malta is establishing itself as a proactive advocate of ethical and human-centric AI within the European Union. Anchored in the EU's evolving regulatory landscape, Malta has adopted an alignment-driven approach that emphasizes rights-based safeguards, regulatory experimentation, and fostering innovation. Rather than introducing standalone AI legislation, Malta is leveraging its national AI strategy and soft-law instruments to promote trustworthy AI development.

At the heart of Malta's evolving AI governance strategy is its direct implementation of the EU AI Act, which will apply as of August 2, 2026. A distinctive feature of Malta's approach is its proactive stance on innovation through initiatives like the MDIA AI Applied Research Grant, which provides funding for AI research projects, fostering a learning environment for piloting AI systems.



These are complemented by strategic resources such as the National AI Strategy ("Malta the Ultimate AI Launchpad: A Strategy and Vision for Artificial Intelligence in Malta 2030") and the Ethical AI Framework ("Towards Trustworthy AI"), which together articulate a vision for safe, inclusive, and rights-aligned AI.

Malta's governance model is underpinned by a multi-actor institutional architecture. The Malta Digital Innovation Authority (MDIA) plays a central role in developing the innovative technology sector and realigning the national AI strategy. The intention is also for a National Technology Ethics Committee to be set up under the MDIA to oversee the Ethical AI Framework. These efforts reflect a whole-of-society approach to embedding AI governance within national goals such as public sector modernization and inclusive economic development.

Malta also shows strong commitment to international standards. As an EU member state, the country aligns closely with EU-wide strategies like the EU AI Act. Through these channels, Malta ensures its domestic practices remain interoperable and globally relevant, reinforcing its image as a constructive contributor to human-centric AI governance. Aligned with its National AI Strategy, the country is targeting key sectors—including transport, citizen services, and energy—for AI-enabled transformation. Strategic initiatives and policy instruments, such as the government's planned AI projects to improve citizen services, guide practical, accountable deployment. The Strategy also emphasizes the importance of education and workforce development, helping build a skilled, future-ready workforce.

Malta's data and infrastructure capabilities also reinforce its AI readiness. The National AI Strategy calls for robust digital infrastructure and connectivity to support effective AI applications. Its alignment with EU instruments concerning data governance and efforts to enhance data quality and availability underscore a future-facing commitment to scalable, trustworthy data use. Through this combination of EU-aligned oversight, innovation-driven approaches, and globally harmonized ethics frameworks, Malta is building a comprehensive, adaptive model of AI governance. By prioritizing human rights, transparency, and practical application, Malta is charting a pragmatic course toward AI that is both innovative and democratically grounded.

Appendix A:

Expert Vignettes

This appendix presents short expert vignettes that illustrate how Malta's institutional landscape for AI oversight, coordination and policy implementation operates in practice. Each vignette is written from the perspective of a typical actor (role-based, anonymised) and highlights institutional responsibilities, accountability arrangements and multi-stakeholder mechanisms that shape trustworthy, inclusive and adaptive AI governance



Sam Boboev, *Founder,* FinTech Wrap Up

Malta's AI governance strategy strikes a smart balance between innovation and oversight—especially relevant for regulated sectors like fintech.



Malta's AI governance strategy strikes a smart balance between innovation and oversight—especially relevant for regulated sectors like fintech. The MDIA sandbox and voluntary certification offer fintechs a safe environment to experiment with AI while staying aligned with EU rules. This is crucial for use cases like fraud detection or compliance automation, where trust and accountability matter as much as performance. The Ethical AI Framework also reflects a forward-thinking approach. Features like human override and bias checks aren't just ethical best practices—they're becoming regulatory necessities in financial services. With the right talent and execution, Malta could position itself as a launchpad for AI-driven fintechs that want to build responsibly from day one.

Biography

Sam Boboev is a fintech enthusiast and product leader passionate about crafting simple solutions for complex problems. He has successfully launched several products in the payments and fintech space, consistently driving growth for early-stage startups and enhancing customer satisfaction for established ventures. Additionally, he runs the Fintech Wrap Up newsletter, sharing the latest industry news and insights, and serve as a pro bono peer mentor in product management, demonstrating my commitment to giving back to the community.

Valentina Diaco, *Founder, Profit Matches*

Malta has the policy vision and institutional framework to lead in ethical AI. But beyond regulation and compliance, there's an equally important layer that needs stronger activation: practical enablement.



Real-World Testbed for Applied AI

To truly become “*the Ultimate AI Launchpad*,” Malta must double down on its potential as a real-world testbed for applied AI, not just governance frameworks, but business applications. This includes the ability to trial AI solutions in high-potential verticals like iGaming, fintech, and utilities, and rapidly iterate them within a supportive, feedback-rich environment. While regulation is maturing through the EU AI Act and MDIA’s Ethical AI Framework, many startups and solution providers, especially in high-growth, high-risk sectors, still face friction when bringing their ideas to market. They don’t just need clarity on what *not* to do; they need help identifying the *right use cases*, strategic partners, and safe piloting environments that align innovation with compliance from day one.

AI Match by Profit Matches

That’s the gap we’re trying to fill with AI Match by Profit Matches: a curated directory and matchmaking layer connecting iGaming, entertainment, and Web3 brands with vetted AI solutions tailored to their real business needs. Tools like this act as essential bridges between governance and adoption. But directories aren’t enough, we also need acceleration.

Accelerator Collaborations to Drive Innovation

That's why I will be collaborating with ELEVATE AI: a 6-month hybrid accelerator built for AI-native startups transforming the gaming industry. From real-time personalization and intelligent content generation to player behavior prediction and compliance tooling, ELEVATE AI provides founders with the technical, strategic, and operational runway to go from prototype to traction-ready. By offering access to corporate challenges, live product testing, and capital introductions, ELEVATE AI directly supports the kind of vertical-specific innovation Malta can uniquely host. It builds on the country's deep iGaming roots and positions it as a launchpad not just for AI policy, but for AI products that perform.

Three-Pronged Opportunity

There's a real opportunity here: (a) For Malta to become a go-to-market hub for applied AI in regulated industries; (b) For regulators, accelerators, and operators to co-create pilots and unlock measurable impact; (c) And for founders to get access not just to funding, but to trusted, live environments that validate their solutions in-market.

This is especially critical for sectors like iGaming often underrepresented in EU tech discourse yet rich with behavioural data and monetizable use cases. Malta is already a global home for these industries. Let's build on that ecosystem and position Malta not just as AI-compliant,, but AI-competitive. Innovation and compliance aren't mutually exclusive. Malta has the institutions, scale, and agility to prove it. Becoming a true AI launchpad means enabling not just the frameworks, but the *last mile of innovation*: the connective tissue that gets bold ideas live, tested, and trusted.

Biography

Valentina Diaco is a strategic marketing advisor, founder of *Profit Matches*, and the creator of *AI Match*, the first curated directory of AI/ML solutions tailored to the iGaming industry. With nearly two decades of experience including leadership roles on both the brand operator and agency sides, she specializes in building performance-driven ecosystems that connect brand, data, and innovation. Known for blending strategic clarity with creative boldness, Valentina works across emerging tech to transform how brands grow, measure impact, and build community. She's also a sought-after speaker, workshop host, and panel moderator, helping companies make smarter matches between tools, audiences, and business models.

Beniamino Santoro, *Group DPO, EveryMatrix*

Malta has advanced the domestic implementation of the EU Artificial Intelligence Act by establishing a coherent institutional framework that ensures regulatory alignment, accountability, and operational readiness.



In October 2025, the Government adopted Legal Notices 226 and 227 under the Malta Digital Innovation Authority Act and the Data Protection Act, thereby designating national competent authorities and formally integrating the EU framework into domestic law. The Malta Digital Innovation Authority (MDIA) serves as the principal Market Surveillance Authority and the national coordination hub for AI oversight.

It monitors the entry of AI systems into the Maltese market, facilitates regulatory dialogue with EU institutions, and enforces compliance through proportionate sanctions. In practical terms, the MDIA's AI sandbox functions as a structured environment enabling enterprises to pilot and validate AI applications under supervision, thereby strengthening compliance capacity and technical competence within the ecosystem.

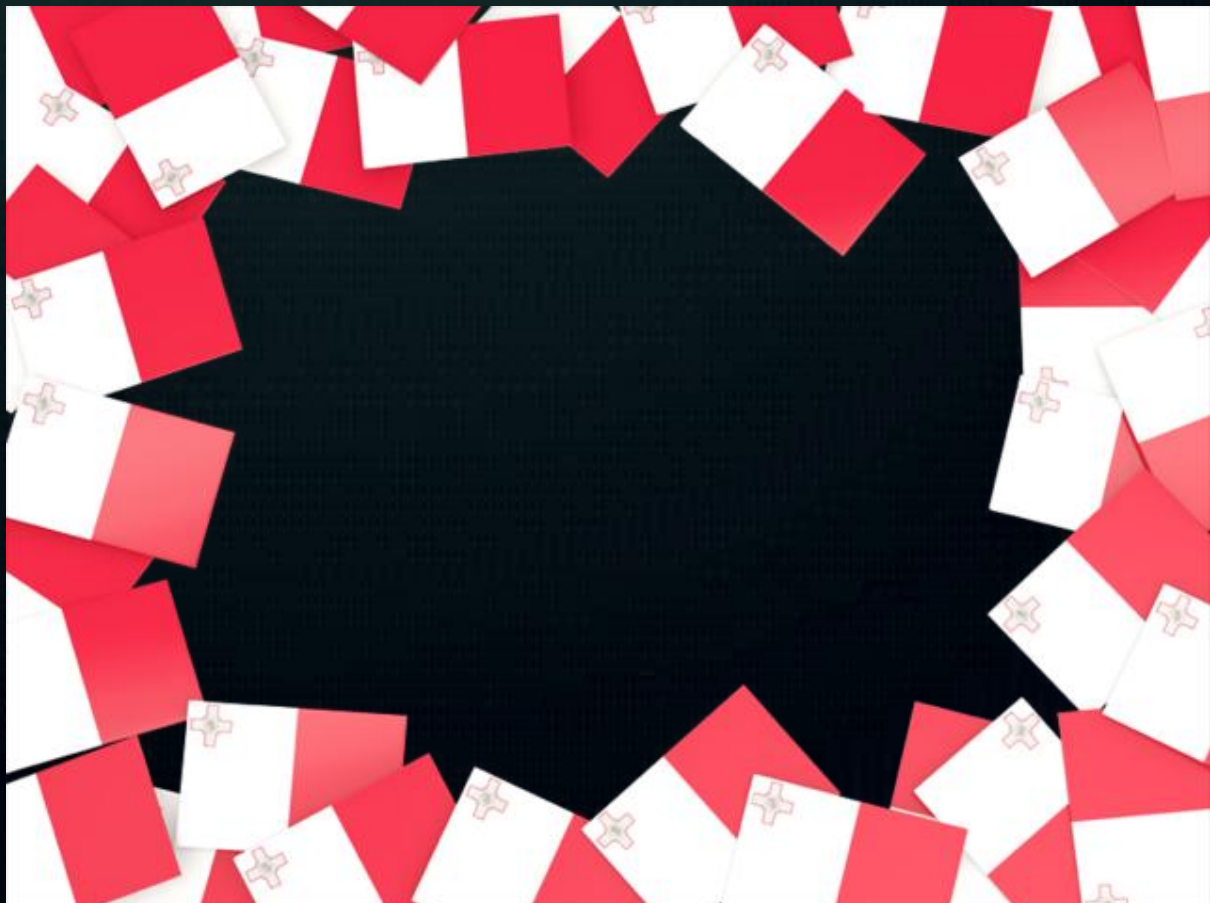
The Information and Data Protection Commissioner (IDPC) operates as the Fundamental Rights Authority and supervises specific high-risk systems. This dual mandate reinforces the safeguards against practices that may impinge upon privacy or due process.

Malta's preparatory measures, rooted in its 2019 National AI Strategy, reflect an evolving institutional maturity and sustained commitment to ethical, transparent, and innovation-driven AI governance.

Biography

Beniamino Santoro is a technology and data protection legal expert specializing in privacy, information security, and AI governance. As Data Protection Officer, he holds leadership positions within multinational companies, startups, and SMEs, guiding strategic compliance and regulatory engagement across diverse operational environments. As a member of the European Data Protection Board's Support Pool of Experts, he advises supervisory authorities on complex regulatory and technical matters pursuant to European data protection and AI law. He also contributes to the Gartner Peer Community, providing insights on privacy and AI risk governance.

He is a Lecturer in Privacy Law and has previously given lessons at institutions including Goethe University and the Leibniz Institute (DIPF), bridging legal obligations with technological implementation. Santoro is further engaged with privacy service providers, advancing operational compliance, innovation, and accountability across global privacy and AI ecosystems.



Appendix B: OECD AI Progress Report

The sections presents updates on Malta's progress in implementing its 2019 national AI strategy, *Malta: The Ultimate AI Launchpad* from the OECD's latest report on EU Member States' AI implementation efforts. It highlights ongoing revisions to align with evolving EU standards and generative AI developments. Key updates include the Malta Digital Innovation Authority's oversight role, new policies on generative AI use in public administration (2024), stakeholder consultations, KPI-based monitoring, and initiatives such as the MDIA Pathfinder scholarship and emerging HPC capabilities supporting AI research and governance.

Malta's national AI strategy, *The Ultimate AI Launchpad* (2019), positioned the country as a small-state leader in ethical, human-centric artificial intelligence. Since its launch, Malta has sought to integrate AI into its digital transformation



agenda, with implementation led by the **Malta Digital Innovation Authority (MDIA)** and supported by an **AI Consultative Expert Group**. The OECD–EU 2025 report notes that Malta’s strategy is currently being updated to reflect the rapid evolution of AI—particularly generative AI—while maintaining regulatory alignment with EU frameworks.

Malta’s approach to AI implementation demonstrates strengths in governance, policy integration, and international coherence. The MDIA ensures strategic alignment with national and European digital priorities, serving as both a regulatory and enabling body. This institutional model—centralised yet consultative—has helped foster inter-ministerial coordination and stakeholder engagement, including government, academia, and industry. Public consultations and benchmarking exercises have informed the strategy’s refresh, although, as the report highlights, the results of impact assessments have not been made public, raising questions about transparency and accountability.

A significant development in 2024 was Malta’s issuance of the **Generative AI Tools Usage Policy** for public administration. This policy prioritises human-centred accountability, data confidentiality, and responsible innovation—principles consistent with the EU’s AI Act. Such measures indicate Malta’s recognition of emerging AI risks and its commitment to ethical deployment in governance contexts. However, implementation capacity remains constrained by Malta’s small size, limited R&D infrastructure, and modest AI talent pool.

To address talent shortages, Malta has introduced initiatives such as the **Pathfinder MDIA Digital Scholarship**, which funds postgraduate and PhD research in AI, machine learning, and quantum technologies. While commendable, these programmes are small in scale and insufficient to build a robust AI ecosystem without broader incentives for private-sector innovation and academic collaboration. Furthermore, Malta’s participation in EU digital initiatives—such as the upcoming **AI regulatory sandbox** mandated under the EU AI Act—will be essential for fostering experimentation within safe, ethical frameworks.

Monitoring and evaluation represent another positive dimension of Malta’s strategy. Regular tracking of key performance indicators (“action points”) supports evidence-based policy adaptation. Yet, the effectiveness of this monitoring depends on data transparency and inter-agency cooperation—areas that require strengthening. The OECD report identifies Malta among the

countries actively tracking progress against the EU Digital Decade targets, suggesting an encouraging level of policy maturity.

Nonetheless, challenges persist. Malta's AI ecosystem is still heavily reliant on public sector leadership, with limited private-sector innovation capacity. The island's economy, while digitally advanced, faces constraints in scaling AI-intensive industries beyond fintech and digital services. Moreover, AI governance mechanisms must be continuously updated to ensure compliance with forthcoming EU regulations and to anticipate cross-sectoral risks, especially in healthcare, education, and justice.

Constructively, Malta could deepen its AI implementation by:

1. Expanding open data initiatives and AI sandboxes to stimulate research and start-up participation.
2. Increasing investment in AI R&D infrastructure, possibly through EU partnerships.
3. Publishing periodic progress and impact reports to enhance transparency.
4. Fostering public awareness and ethical literacy around AI use.

**Expand open data
initiatives**

**Increase
investment in AI
R&D infrastructure**

**Publish periodic
progress reports**

**Foster public
awareness**

In summary, Malta's AI implementation shows steady, principled progress underpinned by strong governance and ethical foresight. Yet, sustained investment, institutional openness, and cross-sector collaboration will determine whether Malta can truly fulfil its ambition to be Europe's "ultimate AI launchpad."

References

This section compiles all primary and secondary sources cited—legal texts, policy papers, academic studies, and official reports. It provides a transparent basis for the report’s analyses and recommendations, enabling verification, further research, and continued dialogue on AI policy and governance in Malta.

Center for AI and Digital Policy, (2025), ‘Artificial Intelligence and Democratic Values 2025’, accessible at: <https://www.caidp.org/reports/aidv-2025/> (last accessed 3rd May 2025)

European Commission, (2025), ‘Digital Decade 2025: Country reports’, accessible at <https://digital-strategy.ec.europa.eu/en/library/digital-decade-2025-country-reports> (last accessed 9th June 2025)

European Parliament and The Council of the European Union, (2024), 2024/1689 Regulation (EU) 2024/1689 of the European Parliament and of The Council of 13 June 2024 laying down harmonised rules on artificial intelligence and amending Regulations (EC) No 300/2008, (EU) No 167/2013, (EU) No 168/2013, (EU) 2018/858, (EU) 2018/1139 and (EU) 2019/2144 and Directives 2014/90/EU, (EU)

2016/797 and (EU) 2020/1828 (Artificial Intelligence Act), accessible at https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/PDF/?uri=OJ:L_202401689 (last accessed 9th June 2025)

OECD.AI, (2025), 'AI in Malta', accessible at: <https://oecd.ai/en/dashboards/countries/Malta> (last accessed 9th June 2025)

OECD, (2025), 'Progress in Implementing the European Union Coordinated Plan on Artificial Intelligence (Volume 1) Member States' Actions', accessible at: https://www.oecd.org/content/dam/oecd/en/publications/reports/2025/11/progress-in-implementing-the-european-union-coordinated-plan-on-artificial-intelligence-volume-1_bb04a5b6/533c355d-en.pdf (last accessed 10th November 2025)

Oxford Insights, (2024), 'Government AI Readiness Index', accessible at: <https://oxfordinsights.com/ai-readiness/ai-readiness-index/> (last accessed 9th June 2025)

Parliamentary Secretariat For Financial Services, Digital Economy and Innovation, (2019). 'Malta, The Ultimate AI Launchpad: A Strategy and Vision for Artificial Intelligence in Malta 2030', accessible at: https://wp.oecd.ai/app/uploads/2021/12/Malta_Ultimate_AI_Launchpad_2019-2030.pdf (last accessed 9th June 2025)

Stanford University: Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence (HAI), (2025)) 'AI Index', accessible at: <https://hai.stanford.edu/ai-index> (last accessed 3rd May 2025)



Important notice

This document has been prepared by AI & Partners B.V. for the sole purpose of enabling the parties to whom it is addressed to evaluate the capabilities of AI & Partners B.V. to supply the proposed services.

Other than as stated below, this document and its contents are confidential and prepared solely for your information, and may not be reproduced, redistributed or passed on to any other person in whole or in part. If this document contains details of an arrangement that could result in a tax or National Insurance saving, no such conditions of confidentiality apply to the details of that arrangement (for example, for the purpose of discussion with tax authorities). No other party is entitled to rely on this document for any purpose whatsoever and we accept no liability to any other party who is shown or obtains access to this document.

This document is not an offer and is not intended to be contractually binding. Should this proposal be acceptable to you, and following the conclusion of our internal acceptance procedures, we would be pleased to discuss terms and conditions with you prior to our appointment. Images used throughout the document have either been produced in-house or sourced from publicly available sources (see **References** for details).

AI & Partners B.V. is the Dutch headquarters of AI & Partners, a global professional services firm. Please see <https://www.ai-and-partners.com/> to learn more about us.

© 2025 AI & Partners B.V. All rights reserved.

Designed and produced by AI & Partners B.V.